

**PURPOSE:** To ensure student safety by regulating assignment scheduling and due dates on days leading up to school breaks in which students must travel home.

**INTRODUCED BY:** Roman Luckett

**BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MISSISSIPPI SCHOOL FOR MATHEMATICS AND SCIENCE SENATE:**

**SECTION ONE (REASONING):**

Many teachers, faculty members, and students voiced concern for student safety after the school week of Nov. 13 through Nov. 17, 2023. During this week, several large assignments and tests coupled with college early action applications (being due Nov. 15) resulted in students sacrificing necessities like sleep to keep up with the mounting workload. One assignment in particular, University English Literature's "Senior Research Paper," was due at 8 AM that Friday. Many seniors stayed up all night Thursday completing the minimum 8-page paper. On Friday, teachers noted the students' sleep deprivation during class. Safety concerns were raised as many sleep-deprived students would be forced to drive over four hours home (a significant portion of this being in the dark) because it was the Friday before Thanksgiving break.

Blame for the endangerment of students has been a point of contention between students and teachers/faculty since the event. Teachers claim that students could have been more proactive in the division of studies, college applications, and long-known assignments. Students argue that the workload imposed upon them was unreasonable and inconsiderate of the many hours they must devote to college applications, sporting events, and other responsibilities. This resolution is not intended to settle any debate of these issues, rather it attempts to secure student safety via methods congruent with MSMS rules and regulations.

After discussion with many teachers (Dr. Morgan, Mrs. Z, and Mr. Richardson), the most optimal solution was concluded to be restricting the latest date and time assignments can be assigned in accordance with MSMS study hours. Both the Hon. Dr. Morgan and Hon. Mrs. Z expressed the idea that restricting the deadline to study hours' end gives this resolution the greatest possible chance of administration's approval, as teachers are encouraged to not assign due dates later than study hours.

By preventing assignments from being due the day (morning or afternoon) in which students must travel home that evening, students will no longer be exposed to mortal danger as they travel home for the holidays.

**SECTION TWO (PROPOSED ACTION):**

All assignments assigned the week before a break in which student travel is mandatory must be due no later than the day before last by study hours' end (9 PM). For example, if Friday is the day in which students will travel home for a break, then all assignments that week shall be assigned no later than 9 P.M. that Thursday.

Late penalties, as indicated on the syllabus of the relevant course, will apply in the same manner as a regular violation.

### **SECTION THREE (APPENDIX):**

Statement provided by MSMS University English Literature Instructor, Hon. Mr. Richardson:

Dear Senator Luckett,

Assuming students are willing to accept the appropriate late penalties enumerated in their teachers' syllabi, requiring major assignments to be due the night before major breaks (or even earlier) is a plan that should have positive effects on student wellbeing.

Thomas B. Richardson

English Teacher

The Mississippi School for Mathematics and Science



Thomas Richardson  
To: Roman Luckett

😊 ↩ ⏪ ⏩ 🗉 ...  
Thu 1/25/2024 2:53 PM

Dear Senator Luckett,

Assuming students are willing to accept the appropriate late penalties enumerated in their teachers' syllabi, requiring major assignments to be due the night before major breaks (or even earlier) is a plan that should have positive effects on student wellbeing.

Thomas B. Richardson  
English Teacher  
The Mississippi School for Mathematics and Science